

Macrauchenia

mack-row-KAY-nee-ah



- **When** 7 million–20,000 years ago (Neogene)
- **Fossil location** S. America
- **Habitat** Grasslands
- **Length** 10 ft (3 m)
- **Diet** Leaves and grass

Macrauchenia's nostrils were high up on its skull, between the eyes, leading some experts to suggest that it had a short trunk. Its long neck would have allowed it to feed on trees as well as grazing on the ground. Short thigh bones imply it was not a fast runner, but its leg bones were arranged in such a way as to allow it to twist and turn when running, helping it outfox predators such as the saber-toothed cat *Smilodon*.

The snout may have looked like a short trunk.



MAMMALS

